

NICHE BOOK PROFITS

The KDP Launch Checklist

From validated niche to a live, indexed listing -- checkbox by checkbox.
Print it. Check boxes. Publish the book.

Work the phases in order, one title at a time. Research and building happen in private; nothing is public until upload day, and upload day is only safe because every earlier box is checked. If a box doesn't make sense yet, the matching course lesson covers it -- don't skip the box, learn the step.

Phase 1 -- Research Done

- ☐ Pick one specific buyer and one specific job the book does (exam prep, log book, planner, journal). 'Everyone' is not a niche.
- ☐ Validate the niche with the numbers method: check the bestseller ranks, review counts, and publication dates of the top titles before committing.
- ☐ Confirm the demand is shared -- several recent titles are selling in this niche, not one lucky outlier carrying the whole category.
- ☐ Study the top 10 competitors and write down their page counts, trim sizes, prices, and cover styles.
- ☐ Draft 7 keyword phrases in the exact words buyers type into Amazon search -- these feed your title, subtitle, and backend keywords.
- ☐ Write your title and subtitle around the strongest keyword phrase: benefit and audience up front, no keyword stuffing.
- ☐ Choose the 2 categories you will select on the details page, and note the browse paths where the book should also surface.
- ☐ Trademark and brand check: no trademarked names, characters, sports teams, celebrities, or logos in the title, keywords, or content.

Phase 2 -- Book Built

- ☐ Interior built at the exact trim size you will publish, with correct margins (and bleed, if the design touches the page edges).
- ☐ Front and back matter in place: title page, copyright page, and a final page that points readers to your other books.
- ☐ Page count lands in a profitable range for your planned price -- run it through the Royalty & Pricing Worksheet before you finish.
- ☐ Interior exported as a print-ready PDF and checked page by page. Every page, not just the first ten.
- ☐ No blank-page errors, no low-resolution images, and no text sitting inside the margin safe zone.

- ☐ Cover built to the exact KDP template size for your trim size AND page count -- spine width changes with page count, so generate the template fresh.
- ☐ Cover proofed at thumbnail size: the title is readable and the book's type is obvious in one glance, because that is how buyers will meet it.
- ☐ AI-content disclosure answers noted: you know exactly how you will answer KDP's AI-generated and AI-assisted questions at upload.

Phase 3 -- Upload Day

- ☐ Details page filled in completely: title, subtitle, series (if any), edition, author or pen name, and description.
- ☐ Description written for a buyer, not a search engine: what the book is, who it is for, page count, size, and how it is used.
- ☐ All 7 backend keyword fields filled with your researched phrases, without repeating words already in your title.
- ☐ Both categories selected, and language and publication date double-checked.
- ☐ Interior and cover uploaded, then every single page checked in the KDP Previewer -- cover, spine, and the first and last pages included.
- ☐ Pricing entered from your worksheet numbers; territories set to worldwide unless you have a specific reason to restrict them.
- ☐ Hit publish, then save the ASIN and listing link the moment the book page appears.

Phase 4 -- Launch Week

- ☐ Listing is live and indexed: search your exact title on Amazon and find your book.
- ☐ Price checked on the live page -- the number a buyer sees matches your worksheet.
- ☐ Preview checked from the product page: the pages a buyer samples are your best pages, in the right order.
- ☐ Categories on the live page are the ones you chose; if the book landed somewhere wrong, fix it through KDP support now, not later.
- ☐ Shared with your own audience -- email list, social posts, channel, or community. Link the listing, skip the hype.
- ☐ Asked early readers for honest reviews only: never paid, never swapped, never from household or family accounts.
- ☐ Started this title's row in the 90-Day Catalog Planner tracking table: live date, price, first units.

Phase 5 -- First 30 Days

- ☐ Weekly dashboard check on the same day each week: units ordered and royalties recorded in your tracking table.
- ☐ Review count checked weekly; any critical review read for a fixable product problem (page quality, sizing, clarity).
- ☐ Search position spot-checked: search your main keyword phrase and note where the book appears.
- ☐ If something is off, change ONE thing at a time -- cover, price, or keywords -- so you know what caused any shift.
- ☐ Day 30: make the refresh-or-retire decision. Refresh the cover or keywords, reprice, or retire the title and carry the lesson into the next book.
- ☐ Title 2 research started while Title 1 settles. The catalog is the business -- no title gets a verdict before day 30, and no month ends without the next book in motion.

The two rules that keep this checklist honest: never upload a file you have not previewed page by page, and never judge a title before day 30. KDP rewards catalogs, not hunches -- finish the title in front of you, record what it taught you, and let the next book be smarter.